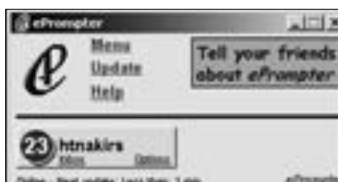


ePrompter supports POP3 servers, besides the popular free Web-based mail providers such as Gmail, Yahoo!, and Hotmail. Once the server details are entered during setup, the program minimises to a system tray icon. The fre-



Part of the ePrompter window

quency of checking the mailbox can be set. The system tray icon shows the number of new mails. By default, ePrompter reads only the e-mail headers, so you can't read the entire message. This behaviour can be changed to allow the entire mail including the body to be downloaded by ePrompter. E-mails can be deleted right on the server without them being downloaded.

ePrompter also can be used to compose and send mails, in which case a line is appended below the mail stating its source. Though ePrompter offers the services of a “general SMTP server” for outgoing emails, this is not reliable, so to send mails, you'll need to enter your email SMTP details too.

ePrompter supports up to 16 mail accounts. One minor but jarring habit of ePrompter is its insistence on overlooking the “mail read” status on the server—at least in the case of Gmail.

5.7 IM Clients

Most free IM service providers have their own dedicated client—Yahoo!, MSN, Rediff, ICQ, Google Talk, etc. are all dedicated IM clients of the respective service providers. Each of these clients has their own features which are influenced by the services offered by the providers, and mostly, they do not allow cross communication. (Only recently did Yahoo! and MSN Live allow cross communication.) We shall review Cross Platform IM Clients (CPIMC)—applications that allow users to chat with people on different clients. Interestingly, Google Talk seems to be ignored by most CPIMC makers.